

Three Dice Roleplaying — Quick Rules Primer

David Brunger

A fast cinematic roleplaying system using only three six-sided dice. This game is built around one idea:

Every roll answers two questions: Did you succeed?—
and What else happened?

You never just "fail." Something always changes.

What You Need

- Three six-sided dice (3d6)
- Two of one colour (Outcome Dice)
- One of a different colour (Consequence Die)

The Core Roll

Whenever a character attempts something risky:

Roll 2d6 (Outcome Dice) + 1d6 (Consequence Die)

Outcome (Did it work?)

Add the two Outcome Dice together and compare to a target number.

Outcome	Result
2 - 3	Strong Failure
4 - 5	Failure
6 - 7	Mixed Success
8 - 9	Success
10 - 12	Strong Success

Interpretation:

- **Strong Failure:** you don't achieve your goal at a cost.
- **Failure:** you don't achieve your goal.
- **Mixed Success:** you achieve your goal imperfectly or at a cost.
- **Success:** you achieve your goal.
- **Strong Success:** you achieve your goal cleanly or gain extra benefit.

Consequence (What else happened?)

Look only at the third die.

Die	Effect
1	Major Threat
2	Minor Threat
3 - 4	Neutral
5	Minor Advantage
6	Major Advantage

Interpretation:

- **Threat:** The GM introduces a complication or obstacle.
- **Advantage:** The player gains a benefit or opportunity.

Example Advantages

- gain cover
- reposition
- potentially something useful
- assist an ally (+1 band to next roll)
- create an opportunity
- reduce time

Example Threats

- make noise
- drop equipment
- lose time
- attract attention
- enemy reposition
- equipment trouble

Doubles Rule (Cinematic Moments)

If the two outcome dice match:

Dice	Result
Double 1	Catastrophe — things go very wrong
Double 6	Triumph — a dramatic positive event

Who Rolls

Players roll for their everything. Instead of "the enemy attacks you," the question becomes: "Do you avoid being hit?"

Characteristics

Characteristics describe what kind of person you are. They do not add numbers. They change how difficult actions are for you.

Each characteristic has 5 levels:

Level	Description
1	Frail — often outmatched
2	Ordinary — typical adult
3	Capable — fit or naturally talented
4	Exceptional — noticeably impressive
5	Remarkable — people comment on it

Before rolling, the GM decides how demanding the task is:

Level	Description
Basic	most people can do this
Challenging	requires training
Hard	Capable — requires expertise
Extreme	rare ability needed

After the roll, compare your characteristic to the demand.

Comparison	Effect
Far Above	+2 outcome bands
Above	+1 outcome band
Equal	no change
Below	-1 band
Far Below	-2 outcome bands

Skills

Skills represent training and experience. Skills do not add numbers. They improve reliability and control.

Each skill has ranks:

Level	Description	Effect
0	Untrained	roll normally
1	Trained	reroll 1 outcome die
2	Professional	reroll both outcome dice
3	Expert	shift consequence ± 1
4	Veteran	reroll consequence die
5	Master	choose consequence result

Difficulty

When facing an NPC, their skill modifies the result instead of rolling dice.

NPC Skill	Effect
Weak	shift result +1 band
Normal	no change
Hard	shift result -1 band
Extreme	shift result -1 band and add a Threat

The Resolution Procedure

Every roll follows this order:

- Player describes action
- Roll 2d6 + 1d6
- Apply skill effects (rerolls/control)
- Determine outcome band
- Apply characteristic shift
- Apply NPC difficulty (if any)
- Apply consequence die
- Narrate result